Exploratory Data Analysis of Wholesale and Retail Vegetable Prices: Dambulla to Pettah

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Preface

Vegetable prices are part of everyday life in Sri Lanka. They influence household budgets, farmer incomes, market decisions, and national conversations about cost of living. Behind these movements lie patterns, structures, and stories waiting to be explored.

This book presents an exploratory data analysis (EDA) of vegetable prices in Sri Lanka, focusing on Dambulla and Pettah. Rather than beginning with complex models, the aim is to start with curiosity—visualizing the data, identifying trends, detecting seasonality, examining volatility, and understanding price relationships between wholesale and retail markets.

Exploratory data analysis is not merely a technical exercise. It is a way of thinking. Through careful visualization and structured exploration, we allow the data to speak before imposing assumptions. This approach helps uncover meaningful insights that can inform researchers, policymakers, traders, and students interested in market dynamics.

This work is intended for learners, analysts, and practitioners who believe that understanding begins with exploration. May these pages encourage you to look at data not just as numbers, but as narratives of real markets and real lives.

1 Data

1.1 Secondary Data

1.2 Webscrapping

1.3 Final dataset

1.4 R Package

```r
library(vegetablesSriLanka)
data("vegetables.srilanka")
head(vegetables.srilanka)
```

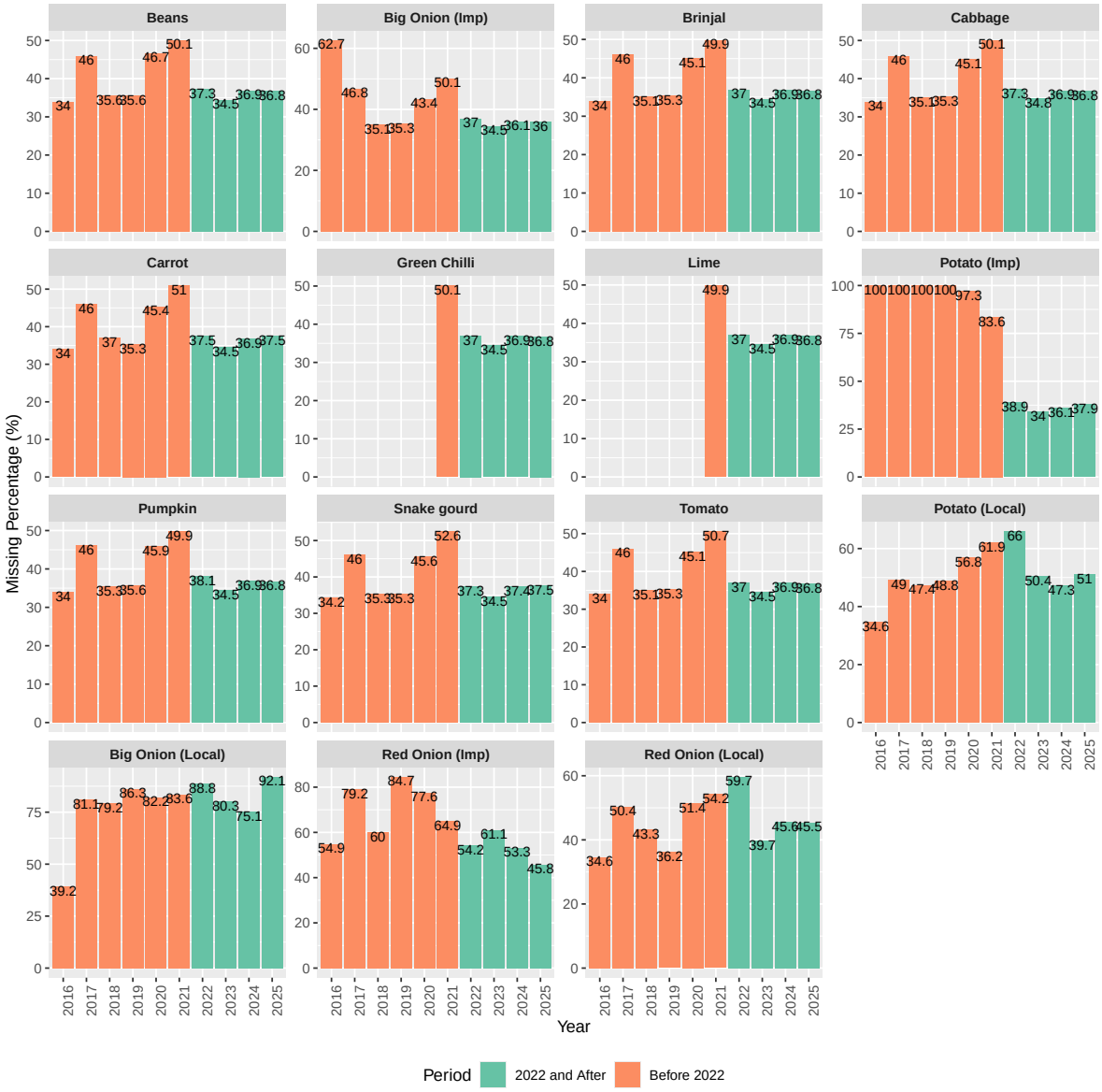
```
        Date  Item   Type   Market Price
1 2016-08-01 Beans Retail Dambulla   165
2 2016-08-02 Beans Retail Dambulla   190
3 2016-08-03 Beans Retail Dambulla   190
4 2016-08-04 Beans Retail Dambulla   190
5 2016-08-05 Beans Retail Dambulla   190
6 2016-08-08 Beans Retail Dambulla   190
```

2 Missing Value Distributions

2.1 Dambulla

2.1.1 Dambulla: Wholesale Price

2.1.2 Dambulla: Retail Price



2.2 Pettah

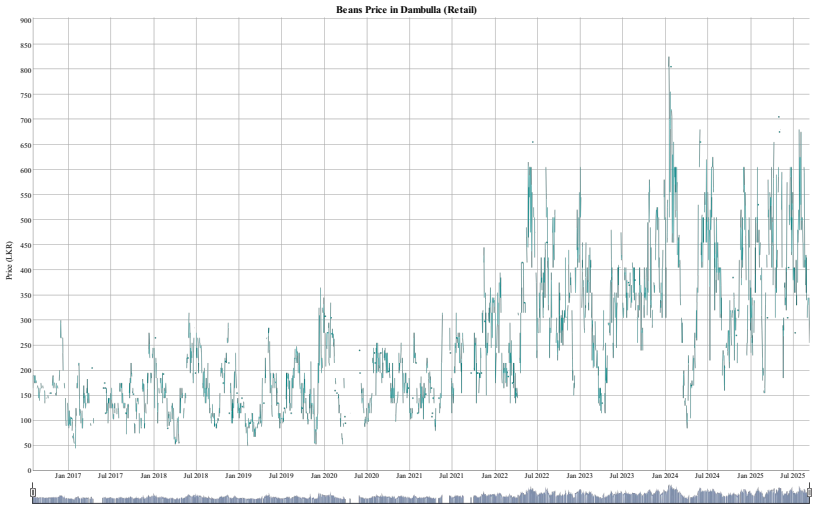
2.2.1 Pettah: Wholesale Price

2.2.2 Pettah: Retail Price

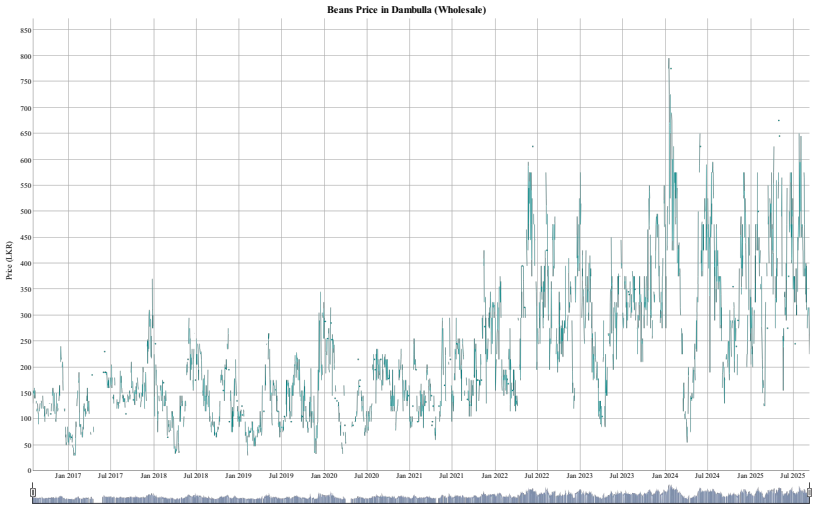
3 Beans

3.1 Dynamic Time Series Plot

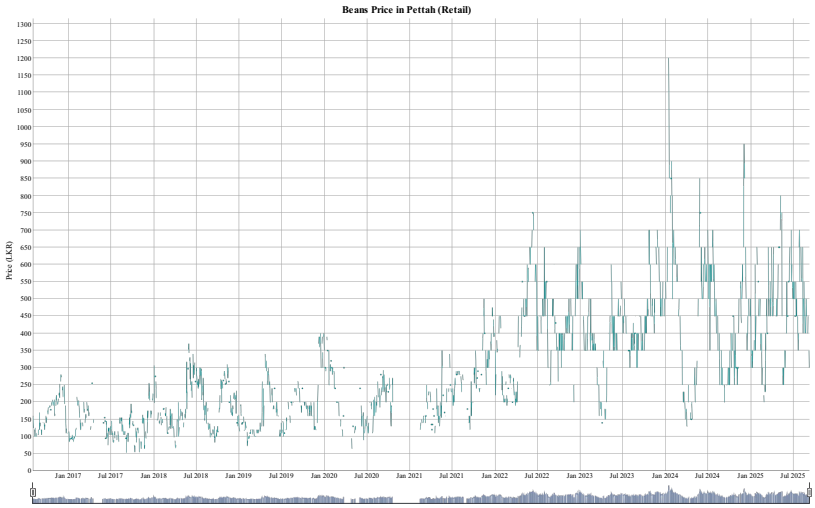
3.1.1 Dambulla: Retail



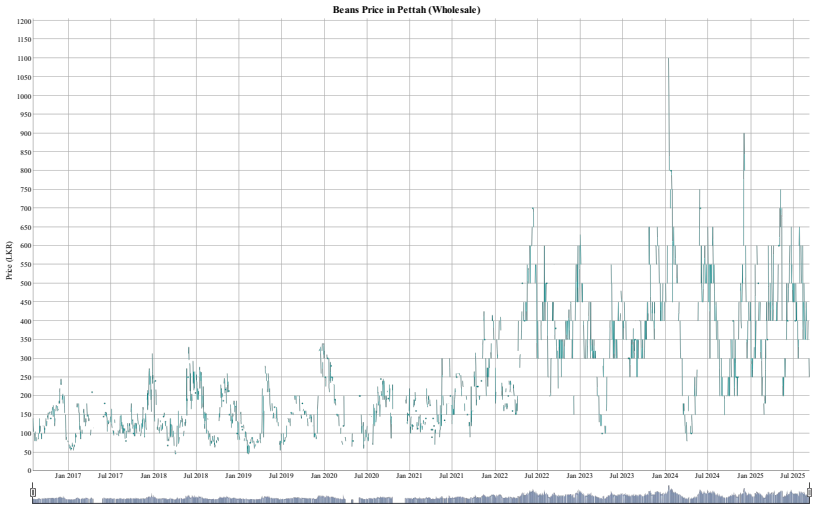
3.1.2 Dambulla: Wholesale



3.1.3 Pettah: Retail



3.1.4 Pettah: Wholesale



4 Summary

In summary, this book has no content whatsoever.

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